



UC Berkeley
Zero Waste

Nº 01 ————— A FIELD GUIDE TO ZERO WASTE

Gateway Zero Waste

First in the World

Welcome to Gateway. Here's everything you need to know about how we handle waste in this building... and why it matters.

DEPARTMENT GUIDE • FOR NEW HIRES, VENDORS & TEAMS

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SECTION 01 FOUNDATIONS

Building a Zero Waste Culture

Understanding Gateway's mission, goals, waste systems, and the role every occupant plays in achieving TRUE Zero Waste certification

1. Gateway's Mission towards TRUE Zero Waste
2. The Sorting Guide
3. A Quick Reference





THE MISSION

Zero waste is about getting *smarter with our stuff* - reusing, sorting, composting, and recycling, so that as little as possible ends up in a landfill.

What is TRUE Zero Waste?

TRUE → Total Resource Use and Efficiency ← is the international certification that measures how well a building handles waste. Think of it like LEED, but for materials: every container, every coffee cup, every paper towel counted.

Gateway is pursuing the highest level. It's a serious claim and a serious commitment.

Why this matters now

Gateway isn't just another new building on campus - it's designed from the ground up to prove that a large, busy academic building can produce **virtually zero waste**. That's never been done at this scale before.

You don't have to be a sustainability expert. The systems are already built in - all we need is for everyone to do their part.

90%+

WASTE DIVERTED

Target for reduce, reuse, recycle and compost streams combined.

Nº1

PUBLIC UNIVERSITY

First building **in the world** to pursue TRUE certification for both construction and operations.

2030

CARBON NEUTRAL

Supporting the UC system-wide commitment to carbon neutrality.

Our Goals

G.01 Achieve full **TRUE Zero Waste** certification - a first for a new building of this scale.

G.03 Support UC's system-wide commitment to **carbon neutrality by 2030**.

G.05 Reduce remaining landfill-bound discards by at least 1% annually through continuous improvement of Gateway's zero waste systems.

G.02 Divert **90%+ of all waste** from landfill through reduce, reuse, recycle and compost. Gateway adopts this guide as its zero waste policy for building operations.

G.04 Create a **model** other universities and buildings can follow.

Three bins.

One habit.

SECTION 02
THE SORTING GUIDE



GREEN BIN

Compost / 01

Food scraps & peels
Coffee grounds & filters
Napkins & soiled paper
Approved Compostable
serviceware
Tea bags & plant trimmings



BLUE BIN

Recycle / 02

Bottles & aluminum cans
Clean paper & cardboard
Rigid plastics #1 & #2
Glass containers
Empty & rinsed, please



BLACK BIN

Landfill / 03

Last resort only
Foil-lined wrappers
Soft, mixed plastics
Coated paper cups
Anything you're not sure of?
Ask.

Know Your Plastics

*Look for the
Number*

Check the number on the bottom of plastic packaging to make the right choice.

NUMBER	COMMON ITEMS	GATEWAY
 1	Bottles & clear containers Water bottles, soda bottles, clear food containers	 Recycle
 2	Milk, detergent & shampoo bottles Milk jugs, detergent bottles, shampoo & body wash bottles	 Recycle
 3-7	Most other plastics Plastic film, chip bags, yogurt cups, takeout lids, utensils, mixed plastics	 Landfill

NOT EVERYTHING THAT SOUNDS GREEN IS.

Plant-based, **biodegradable**, and **bioplastic** products are not always compostable.

Only compost items that are approved for Gateway compost collection.

When in doubt, use the landfill bin.

Why No Desk-Side Trash Bins?

Gateway uses centralized waste stations to improve sorting, reduce contamination, minimize plastic liner use, and support efficient building operations. This approach aligns with the Campus-wide transition away from desk-side waste collection.

Quick Reference

KEEP THIS WITHIN REACH.

01 • POLICIES

01

The ground rules

Orientation: all new hires and vendors review this guide upon joining Gateway.

Purchasing agents: prefer durable / reusable goods, prioritize sustainably produced paper and wood products, give preference to used, refurbished, or remanufactured goods, and work with approved vendors.

Follow all UC Berkeley zero waste & single-use plastic policies.

Black bin - Landfill (last resort only)

02 • WASTE SORTING

02

Where it goes

Green bin - Compost (food scraps, soiled paper)

Blue bin - Recycling (bottles, cans, paper)

Black bin - Landfill (last resort only)

Terracycle bin - Empty pen refills/ office supply waste

See the full Sorting Guide on page 3.

03 • SIGNAGE & LEADERSHIP

03

Lead a green team

Color-coded signs at every bin station.

QR codes link to sorting resources.

Become a leader - appoint a Green Team Representative to liaise with Building Operations.

04 • CONTACT

04

Get in touch

Zero Waste Coordinator - sbunke@berkeley.edu

Building Operations - specora@berkeley.edu

Report an issue - Facilities work order system

Watch for our Quarterly Zero Waste Updates.

Get *rewarded*.

We incentivize great ideas. Share your waste-reduction strategies with your Zero Waste Coordinator - outstanding departmental initiatives will be highlighted and rewarded in our quarterly reviews.

"You're not just moving into a new building - you're joining something bigger."

Gateway was designed to show the world that a building full of busy people can still send almost nothing to landfill. The sorting stations, reusable kitchens and composting systems are all here. The only missing piece is you.

Welcome to Gateway. Let's make it count.

Questions?

Contact your Zero Waste Coordinator

ENDORSED BY

Dean / Department Chair / Building Director — this endorsement demonstrates upper management's commitment to Gateway's zero waste goals.

sustainability.berkeley.edu

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SECTION 02

CIRCULAR

OPERATIONS

How Materials Stay in Circulation

From Circularity Kits and ReUse Stations to environmentally preferred purchasing, discover how Gateway keeps materials in use and out of landfill.

1. [The Circular Office Supply System](#)
2. [Gateway Starter Kits](#)
3. [ReUse Stations](#)
4. [Procurement Guidelines: Overview](#)
5. [Procurement Guidelines: Department Purchasing Procedures](#)



The Circular Office Supply System

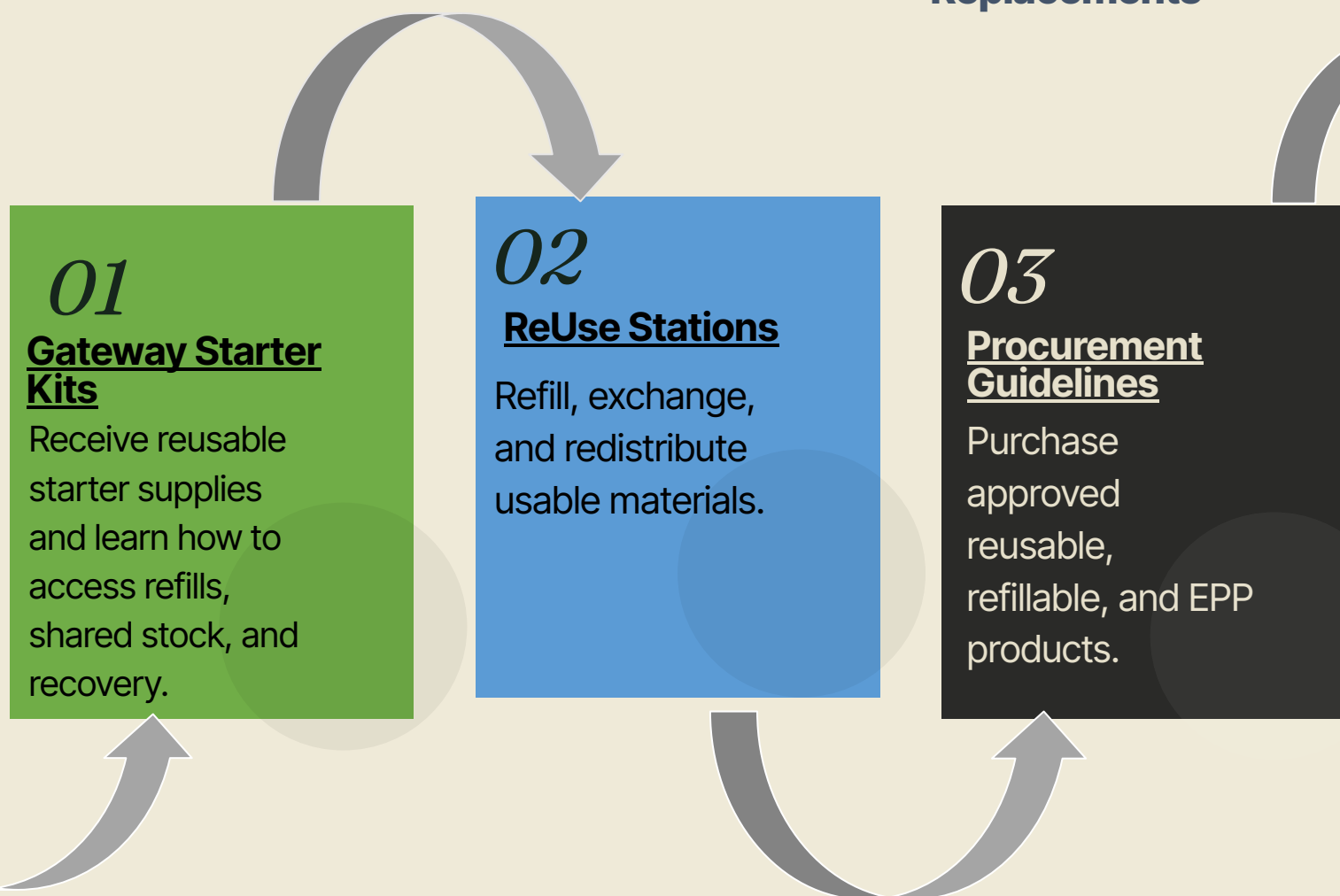
SECTION 02
THE Overview

Follow the flow below to see how materials move through Gateway.

**1: Receive Your
Starter Supplies**

**2: Refill Them &
Redistribute**

**3: Purchase
Approved
Replacements**



Keep Materials in Circulation.

01

Gateway Starter Kits



Supporting every department!

Your introduction to Gateway's Circular Office Supply System.

■ What's Included

.01 Refillable Writing System

- Pilot B2P refillable pens
- Refillable Whiteboard markers

Visit the **Refill Hub** in any ReUse Station to keep your supplies in use!

.02 Shared Office Supplies

- Surplus binders
- File folders
- Clipboards
- Paper clips
- Organizational materials

Stored in **ReUse Stations**.

.03 Specialty Recycling

- Empty pen refill cartridges
- Worn-out pens, markers & highlighters
- Mechanical pencils & pen caps

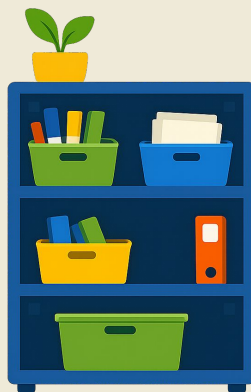
Drop off items in the **Recovery Bin** (Terracycle Zero Waste Box) located at the Level 2 ReUse Station.

.04 Getting Started

- Gateway Zero Waste Manual
 - Waste Sorting Guide
 - Procurement Guide

02

ReUse Stations



Find them on each floor!

Shared Refill & Redistribution Infrastructure

ReUse Stations are centralized hubs for refill, redistribution, and shared supplies.

What's Inside?

ReUse Station Functions 01

Gateway ReUse Stations allow occupants and departments to:

- Donate usable office supplies
- Collect shared materials
- Access refill stock for **Gateway's reusable writing supplies**
- Reduce duplicate purchasing
- Support refill and reuse systems across the building

ReUse stations do NOT serve as a dumping space.

Refill Hub Contents: 02

- Pilot G2 pen ink refills
- Whiteboard marker refill cartridges

Shared Stock Contents:

- Shared office supplies
- Reusable organization materials (file organizers, dividers, binders)
- Paper clips
- Approved redistribution items

Education & Guidance 03

ReUse Stations also serve as educational hubs containing guides, signage, and operational resources related to:

1. Waste Sorting
2. Refill Instructions
3. Sustainable Event Guidelines
4. Catering Policies
5. Procurement Guidelines
6. Ordering procedures for approved supplies
7. Gateway TRUE Zero Waste initiatives

Check ReUse stations before ordering new supplies.

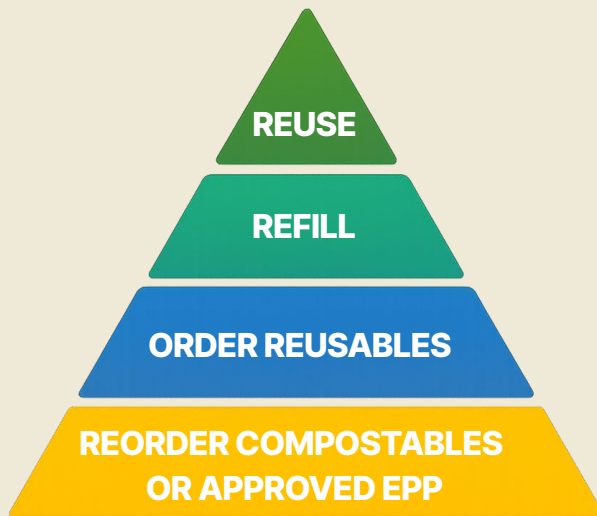
03

Procurement Guidelines Overview

Procurement Policies & Environmentally Preferred Purchasing (EPP) Standards

These guidelines establish purchasing practices that support Gateway's Circular Office Supply System through reuse, refill, and environmentally preferred purchasing.

Gateway Purchasing Hierarchy



ELIMINATE LANDFILL-BOUND MATERIALS

Approved Products

Approved Environmentally Preferred Products (EPPs) are identified within BearBUY and approved vendor catalogs.

Departments should prioritize EPP-designated products, refillable systems, reusable alternatives, and products with minimal packaging. Preference should be given to vendors that support zero waste goals and offer recyclable, reusable, compostable, or returnable packaging options.

1) Reuse existing supplies and select redistributed items in ReUse Stations.

2) Refill reusable items using refill stock available at ReUse Stations.

3) Order reusable and refillable products through the Gateway Approved Products Catalog.

4) Use Approved Compostables and EPP when reuse is not feasible.

Find Approved Products in the:
[Gateway Approved Products Catalog](#)

Recycled Paper Standards:

- Office paper: ≥30% post-consumer recycled content
- Janitorial paper products: ≥20% post-consumer recycled content

For more information, see [Department Purchasing Procedures](#)

03

Procurement Guidelines

■ Department Purchasing Procedures

Gateway supports two purchasing pathways: coordinated purchasing as the preferred method for acquiring office supplies, and individual department restocking when department-specific purchases are necessary.

- **Coordinated & Bulk Purchasing (Preferred)**

Departments should coordinate larger purchases, shared orders, and specialty requests whenever feasible to:

- reduce packaging waste
- consolidate deliveries
- support reusable delivery systems
- improve purchasing efficiency
- reduce duplicate ordering

Coordinated orders may also qualify for volume discounts.

- **Individual Specialty Purchases**

Before placing an order, consult the

[Gateway Approved Products Catalog](#)

Approved products may be purchased through BearBUY and approved vendor pathways. Prioritize EPP-designated products whenever available.

SECTION 03 OCCUPANT GUIDELINES & POLICIES

Zero Waste Actions in Practice

Standards and expectations that support Gateway's zero waste goals in everyday operations.

1. Kitchen Reusables
2. Catering Policies
3. Event Guidelines
4. Café Operations



Kitchen Reusables

Reuse first. Waste less.



Gateway social kitchens operate on a **reuse-first** system. Reusable dishware and supplies are the default for all occupants, helping us reach our **90%+** waste diversion goal.

01 THE SYSTEM -----

What's Available?

- ✓ Reusable plates
- ✓ Reusable bowls
- ✓ Reusable cups
- ✓ Reusable utensils
- ✓ Dishwashing equipment
- ✓ Cleaning & return stations

02 HOW IT WORKS -----

1 - Use



Choose reusable dishware for all meals, snacks, and beverages.

2 - Sort



Scrape food waste into compost bins or Mill units where available. Dispose of all other trash properly.

3 - Clean



Place dishware in designated dishwashers or cleaning areas.

03 EXPECTATIONS -----

Help Keep the System Running.

- Avoid single-use items whenever possible
- Do not remove shared dishware from kitchen spaces
- Help maintain cleanliness for shared use
- Report low inventory or issues as needed

04 WHEN NOT FEASIBLE ----

Reusables are the Standard.

ONLY when reusables are absolutely not feasible individuals must:

- Use the next best option provided (e.g. compostable materials)
- Ensure proper sorting after use

05 MAINTENANCE -----

Restocking and Continuity.

- Dishwashers will be run on a regular basis.
- If items are missing or supplies are low, notify: sbunke@berkeley.edu



“Every reusable item used is one less item sent to landfill.”

Gateway's kitchens were designed to make the **sustainable** choice the **easy** choice.

Catering Policies

Better food. Less Waste.



All catering at Gateway must support our **zero waste goals** by prioritizing reusable serviceware, minimizing packaging, and reducing unnecessary single-use materials.

01 CORE REQUIREMENTS

- ✓ No default single-use plastics or disposable items
- ✓ Prioritize reusable trays, utensils, and serviceware
- ✓ Plan for proper waste sorting at all events
- ✓ Follow UC Berkeley zero waste standards

02 WHAT TO REQUEST

- Order food in bulk or tray format
- Avoid individually packaged meals whenever possible
- Request reusable serviceware from vendors (utilize Dispatch goods if possible)
- No single-use cutlery or packaging unless specifically requested
- Use compostable alternatives only when reusables are not feasible
- Coordinate with building resources for dishware setup & cleanup

03 EVENT SETUP & WASTE

- Set up clearly labeled Compost, Recycling, Dispatch, & Landfill stations
- Use Gateway-approved signage
- Encourage proper sorting of materials
- Ensure all Dispatch Goods containers are returned to designated return bins
- Coordinate with Cal Zero Waste for larger events when needed

04 APPROVED MATERIALS

✓ Preferred

- Reusable serviceware
- Aluminum
- Glass
- Paper-based compostables
- Fiber-based compostables

✗ Not allowed

- Plastic water bottles
- Styrofoam
- PLA plastics
- #7 "Compostable" plastics



"Every order matters."

*Sustainable events avoid waste
before it's created*

Event Guidelines

Great Events. Zero Waste.



Plan sustainability into the event from the **start**.

01

Waste Stations

Every event must provide:



Compost bins



Recycle bins



Landfill bins

Use Gateway approved signage at all stations.

02

Zero Waste Support

Large event?

Partner with Cal Zero Waste!



Student staff can provide:

- Sorting education
- Participant guidance
- Diversion support

Contact us:
sbunke@berkeley.edu

03

Giveaways & Promotional Items

Choose items people will actually use.

✓ Recommended

- Reusable notebooks
- Ceramic/glass/metal mugs
- Cell phone chargers
- Bamboo cutlery sets

✗ Avoid

- Non-refillable pens
- Plastic pins
- Vinyl stickers
- Cheap or low quality plastic cups and water bottles
- Flimsy keychains
- Low quality polypropylene/plastic tote bags or drawstring bags

04

Decor & Signage

Prioritize reusable materials.

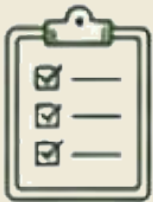
✓ Recommended

- Reusable banners
- Reusable table top displays
- Plastic reusable balloons
- Dried flower petal/leaf confetti
- Paper confetti
- Bubbles (in a plastic free container)
- Reusable tablecloths

✗ Avoid

- Single-use decor
- Disposable signage
- Plastic-heavy decorations

Event Checklist:



- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Catering follows Gateway standards | ☐ Reusables are prioritized |
| ☐ Waste stations are planned | ☐ Giveaways meet sustainability guidelines |
| ☐ Signage is prepared | ☐ Decor is reusable or compostable |



“Every event is an opportunity.”

Every event is a chance to minimize waste and demonstrate what a truly **zero waste** building can look like.

Cafe Operations

Small choices. Big impact.



The Gateway cafe operates on a **reuse-first** model. Every purchase is an opportunity to reduce waste and keep materials in **circulation**.

01 What is Dispatch Goods?

Dispatch goods is a reusable packaging system that replaces single-use takeout containers.



Borrow it. Use it. Return it. We clean it. You use it again!

02 How to return containers.

- Finish your meal.
- Empty food scraps (no need to wash or rinse).
- Return the container to a Dispatch return bin around campus (orange bins).

03 Sort it right.

 COMPOST - Food scraps - Napkins - Compostable/wood serviceware	 RECYCLING - #1 & #2 Plastics only - Glass Bottles - Cans - Clean paper - Cardboard	 DISPATCH - Dispatch containers + lids - Any broken Dispatch items	 LANDFILL - Snack wrappers - #3-7 Plastics - Styrofoam - Coffee lids & straws
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“Reuse starts with you.”

Every reusable container **returned & item sorted** correctly helps Gateway move closer to its **zero waste goals**.

SECTION 04 SUPPORT & RESOURCES

Who to Contact for Questions and Support

Contact	Role	Contact For
Samantha Bunke sbunke@berkeley.edu	Zero Waste Specialist	• Circularity Support, Purchasing & Waste Reduction
Sarah Pecora specora@berkeley.edu	Facilities Manager, CDSS	• Building Operations, Waste Stations & Facility Concerns
fs-general@berkeley.edu	Campus Facilities Services	• Maintenance Requests, Repairs & Custodial Services

Circularity Support

Need assistance with:

- ✓ ReUse Stations
- ✓ Circularity Kit refills
- ✓ Shared inventory
- ✓ Product substitutions
- ✓ Sustainable purchasing

Feedback & Improvements

Help improve Gateway by reporting:

- ✓ Refill system issues
- ✓ Product shortages
- ✓ Opportunities for reusable alternatives
- ✓ New EPP product suggestions
- ✓ Packaging reduction opportunities

